



# New Houston Homeowner's Guide



# Welcome Home!

## THE ENGLISH GUIDE

**Congratulations on your new home! Your house is likely your biggest investment, and taking care of it helps protect both its value and your daily comfort. Studies show that many homeowners regret not doing preventative maintenance, because small issues can grow into costly repairs. This guide will walk you through simple monthly, seasonal, and yearly steps to keep your home, appliances, and even your car in great shape.**



## Smart Financial Tools

- **Home Warranty:** Use the warranty we negotiated in your purchase while it lasts! It can help cover repairs or replacements on systems and appliances.
- **Maintenance Fund:** Build a separate savings fund for surprise repairs. Experts suggest 1–3% of your home's value per year.



## Monthly Maintenance

- **Replace/clean HVAC filters**
- **Test smoke/CO detectors**
- **Run water in unused sinks**
- **Check range hood filter**
- **Walk exterior for cracks, loose siding, or roof damage**



# Quarterly Maintenance

- Clean dryer vent + lint trap - professional deep clean once a year with quarterly vacuum outs of what you can see underneath the lint trap, remember this stuff is flammable and makes your dryer less efficient when it builds up. Lint traps should be emptied between each load of laundry.
- Flush garbage disposal with ice/baking soda
- Check garage door auto-reverse safety
- Inspect under sinks for leaks



# Seasonal Maintenance

## Spring

- Service HVAC (cooling)
- Clean gutters & downspouts
- Inspect roof after winter
- Check irrigation/sprinklers

## Summer

- Water foundation during dry spells
- Inspect attic ventilation
- Check caulking & exterior paint
- Service lawn equipment

## Fall

- Service HVAC (heating)
- Clean chimney & fireplace
- Drain & store garden hoses
- Inspect weather stripping

## Winter

- Wrap pipes & outdoor faucets
- Let faucets drip during freezes
- Run ceiling fans clockwise
- Protect outdoor faucets



# Annual Maintenance

- Flush water heater
- Professional HVAC service (spring/fall)
- Professional dryer vent cleaning
- Clean septic (if applicable)
- Wash home's exterior
- Inspect foundation for cracks
- Deep clean carpets & tile grout



## Appliance & Home Systems

- Refrigerator: Vacuum coils twice yearly
- Dishwasher: Vinegar cycle monthly
- Washer: Keep door open after use
- Dryer: Always clean lint trap
- Fireplace: Annual inspection/cleaning



## Extreme Houston Weather

### HEAT

- Water foundation with soaker hose
- Shade windows to lower cooling costs
- Service HVAC before 100°F+ temps

## FREEZE

- **Wrap pipes & drip faucets**
- **Open cabinets under sinks on exterior walls**

## HURRICANES & FLOODING

- **Trim trees & clean gutters**
- **Store outdoor furniture**
- **Install surge protectors**
- **Keep sandbags/flood barriers ready**
- **Store documents in waterproof containers**
- **Keep a shovel handy. If your yard is sloped toward your house you may need to dig a trench around your home to divert water to the street. French drain systems are also a great way around this issue as well but are a more costly solution and you may realize you need this a little too late to do anything about this. Consult with a foundation specialist and/or drainage contractor if you see a lot of pooling in your yard on a regular basis.**



## Furniture Maintenance

- **Wood: Dust weekly, polish twice yearly**
- **Upholstery: Rotate cushions, vacuum often**
- **Leather: Condition every 3–6 months**
- **Outdoor: Rinse after storms, cover cushions**



# Vehicle Maintenance

- **Check coolant & AC before summer**
- **Rotate tires every 5–7k miles**
- **Flush brakes before rainy season**
- **Protect with wax/detailing before storm season**
- **Be sure to never keep electronics stored in your car – it's a fire and theft risk and it's simply not worth it.**



# Closing Note

**A home is more than walls and a roof—it's your sanctuary. With a little routine care, you'll protect its value, avoid costly repairs, and keep it comfortable for years to come.**

**-Thanks for trusting me to help you with your home!**

**If you ever need anything or have any questions I'd always be more than happy to help. If you need referrals to just about any kind of vendor, service provider, or professional you can think of I probably have a great one you can call. Let me continue to be a resource to you for years to come! After all, the right trusted connections – like the right homes – are always worth circling back to. Until then, may your lives be filled with God's favor and joy in abundance!**



**Fay Brink, Your Houston Realtor®**  
**c: 832-723-3025**